

About the Corolla Wild Horse Fund

For centuries, wild Banker horses outnumbered humans on the Outer Banks. The original stock was brought to the New World by the Spanish in the 1500s. In May of 1926, The National Geographic Magazine reported that there were between 5,000 and 6,000 wild horses roaming the Outer Banks of the North Carolina coast. Since then, their population has significantly decreased.

A few decades ago, the road between Duck and Corolla was little more than a dirt path and the horses lived freely among the local villagers. Everything changed in 1985 with the paving of the road between Duck and Corolla. In the decade that followed, twenty horses were injured or killed by cars. It became clear that if the horses were to survive the increasing development, something needed to be done.

In 1989, a group of caring citizens recognized the need to raise public awareness of the wild horses living between the town of Duck and Corolla, therefore the Corolla Wild Horse Fund was formed.

Prioritizing the safety of the herd, the Corolla Wild Horse Fund worked with local government to develop a plan to protect the historic and endangered horses in their rapidly changing environment.

In 1996, through the efforts of this all-volunteer organization and their hard work to raise \$50,000, a sound-to-sea fence was built just north of Corolla. The remaining wild horses were then moved to the north beaches for their protection. A second fence 11 miles to the north at the Virginia state line was also financed by their actions. Between the south and north fence is a total of 7,544 acres of mixed-use land: federal, state, and private-use land with much development still on the horizon. All contribute to a complicated and threatened life for the horses.

Between the years 1989 and 2001, the Fund was a grassroots organization without paid staff and under the supervision of the Outer Banks Conservationists. In 2001, the Fund was incorporated and registered as a 501 (c) 3 nonprofit charity. Since that time, the Board of Directors has grown from five to nine members, and the professional staff required to deliver the necessary programs and services for the Fund's mission has also increased.

Significant revenue is needed to provide the highest level of protection for the wild horses and to care for rescued horses at our farm on the mainland. Revenue is also required for the DNA research the Fund continually works on, as well as to support the increase in education and awareness that is necessary in such a highly-visited area.

In 2010, the General Assembly of North Carolina designated the Colonial Spanish Mustang as the Official Horse of the State of North Carolina. These horses have been officially recognized as their own distinct breed, Banker, by the Equus Survival Trust in recent years. The Bankers are deemed critically endangered. The Fund relies on the generosity of the public to conserve the horses, receiving no state or federal funding.

The Fund operates a museum and gift shop in Corolla, a 31-acre rehabilitation facility on the mainland to care for horses that must be removed from the beach, an educational website, and an online store. Our organization is privileged to share the story of the wild horses living along the Outer Banks of North Carolina with thousands of visitors each year.

The Corolla Wild Horse Fund feels that it is important to educate the public about the significant role that the Banker horses of Corolla have played in the history and culture of North Carolina's coastal area for hundreds of years.

It is significant noting that all proceeds from our programs and sales go back to benefit the horses as they continue to live on the State's shores.

Memberships and donations are vital to the health and strength of the Corolla Wild Horse Fund. Our membership base continues to increase every year. As a supporter of the Corolla Wild Horse Fund, you can help us keep the Banker horses wild and free.

Corolla Wild Horse Fund • PO Box 361 • Corolla, NC 27927
Learn more about us and the horses at corollawildhorses.org.
Keep up with the herd online through *Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, and YouTube.*

